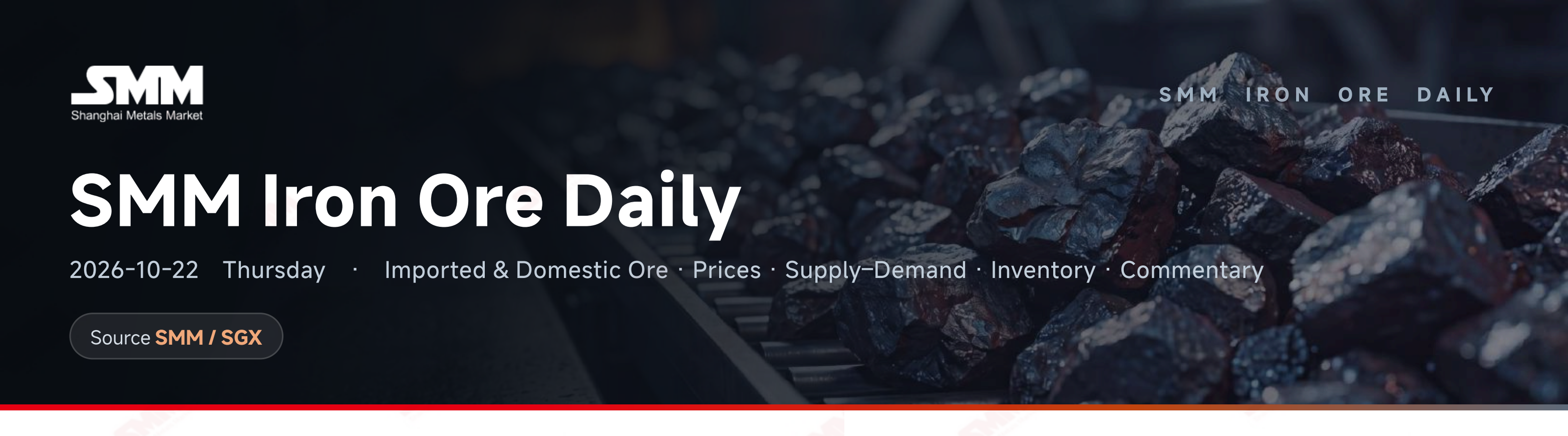


SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-22 Thursday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

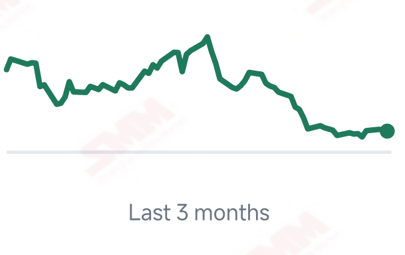
Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.55
USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-22 17:58:46 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-22 17:43:50 (UTC+8)



Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

669.0
yuan/mt
▼ -12.5 -1.83%
MTD avg **678.0**
As of Oct 22 · vs Oct 21

Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 22

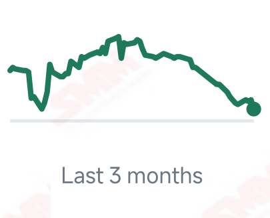
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

656
yuan/wmt
▼ -5 -0.76%
MTD avg **659**

Last 3 months

MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

611
yuan/wmt
▼ -6 -0.97%
MTD avg **618**



Last 3 months

MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

815
yuan/wmt
▼ -5 -0.61%
MTD avg **820**

Last 3 months

MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

88.60
USD/dmt
▼ -1.80 -1.99%
MTD avg **90.45**

Last 3 months

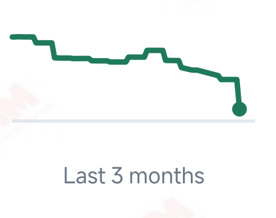
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.25
USD/dmt
▼ -1.15 -1.07%
MTD avg **108.96**

Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

796.81
yuan/mt
▼ -24.77 -3.01%
MTD avg **818.50**
As of Oct 16 · vs Oct 15



Last 3 months

Key View

Futures and spot prices weaken together; higher hot metal still needs sustained trading support

Today's decline extended across domestic futures, port spot and seaborne markets, testing the earlier recovery again. DCE most-traded closed at 669.0 yuan/mt, down 1.83%, and all eight Qingdao products fell 9 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% index eased to USD 88.60/dmt and the 65% to 106.25, with all 12 brands lower. The aligned price moves indicate that isolated improvements in offers have not generated durable upward momentum.

Production has nevertheless improved at the margin. Surveyed daily hot metal output was 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt from the previous period, alongside a modest increase in the blast furnace operating rate. Higher output is not the same as discretionary restocking: mill stocks, end-user orders and margins still shape purchasing schedules. Lower arrival flows may ease future supply pressure, but existing inventory still requires transactions and collections for absorption.

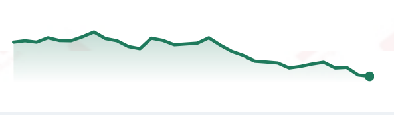
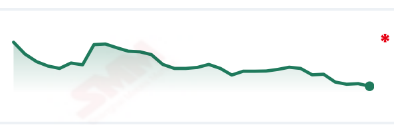
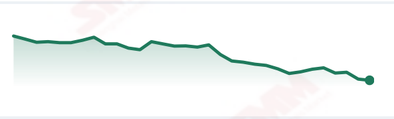
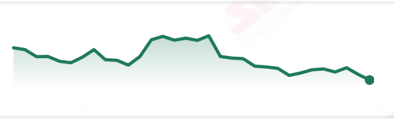
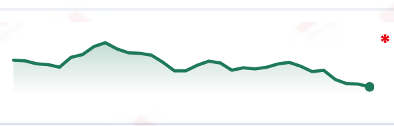
The near-term question is whether lower prices generate persistent demand. Buying restricted to current consumption could leave prices soft and range-bound, while sustained trading and restocking would help translate production improvement into price support. Higher freight adds a cost variable, making selling prices, procurement contracts and exchange rates important to margin assessment rather than extrapolating one day's production or price move into a trend reversal.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and port spot prices fell together.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **669.0 yuan/mt**, down 12.5 yuan (-1.83%) from Oct 21. All eight Qingdao products fell 9 yuan/wmt, with PB Fines at 639, Newman Fines 639, Mac Fines 646 and Carajas Fines 814.
- **Seaborne index declines widened and all brand quotations fell.** The 61% index was **USD 88.60/dmt**, down 1.80 (-1.99%), and the 65% was **106.25**, down 1.15 (-1.07%). All 12 brands declined against the Oct 21 report; PB Fines were 88.90, Newman Fines 88.05 and Mac Fines 88.35 USD/dmt.
- **Port indices declined as the grade spread widened slightly.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 611 and 815 yuan/wmt, down 5, 6 and 5 yuan. The 65%-58% spread widened from 203 to 204 yuan/wmt.
- **Improved production coexists with softer prices.** Surveyed daily hot metal output was 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt from the previous period; the blast furnace operating rate rose 0.13 percentage point to 87.16%. Stronger baseline consumption did not prevent today's quotation declines, keeping sustained purchases and stock absorption in focus.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-22 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	639	▼ -9 -1.39%	646	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	639	▼ -9 -1.39%	648	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	646	▼ -9 -1.37%	650	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	692	▼ -9 -1.28%	698	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	829	▼ -9 -1.07%	839	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	501	▼ -9 -1.76%	508	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	814	▼ -9 -1.09%	825	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	819	▼ -9 -1.09%	833	 *

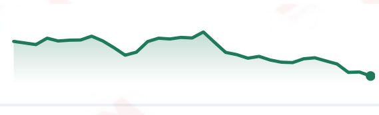
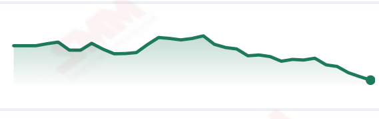
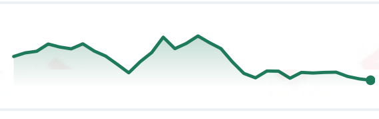
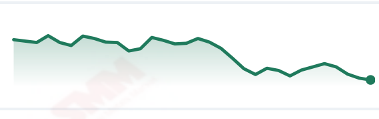
Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-22 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-21
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	85.50	▼ -1.80 -2.06%	87.30
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.20	▼ -1.80 -2.02%	89.00
PB Fines 62% Daily	88.90	▼ -1.80 -1.98%	90.70
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.05	▼ -1.80 -2.00%	89.85
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.35	▼ -1.80 -2.00%	90.15
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.60	▼ -1.45 -1.67%	87.05
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	104.90	▼ -1.80 -1.69%	106.70
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	95.90	▼ -1.80 -1.84%	97.70
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	95.45	▼ -1.80 -1.85%	97.25
RTX Fines 61% Daily	84.55	▼ -1.40 -1.63%	85.95
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	88.60	▼ -1.80 -1.99%	90.40
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.35	▼ -1.45 -1.82%	79.80

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.45	-6.28%	-16.4%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	108.96	-4.78%	-12.4%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.78%	-19.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	820	-2.30%	-9.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	618	-4.48%	-14.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	818.50	-2.39%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 88.60/dmt (-1.99%) and the 65% was 106.25 (-1.07%), widening their spread from USD 17.00 to 17.65/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 611 and 815 yuan/wmt, down 5, 6 and 5 yuan.

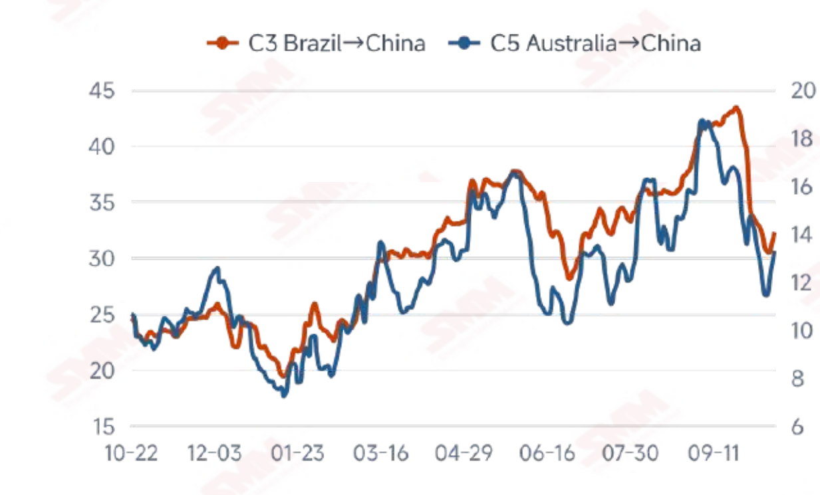
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

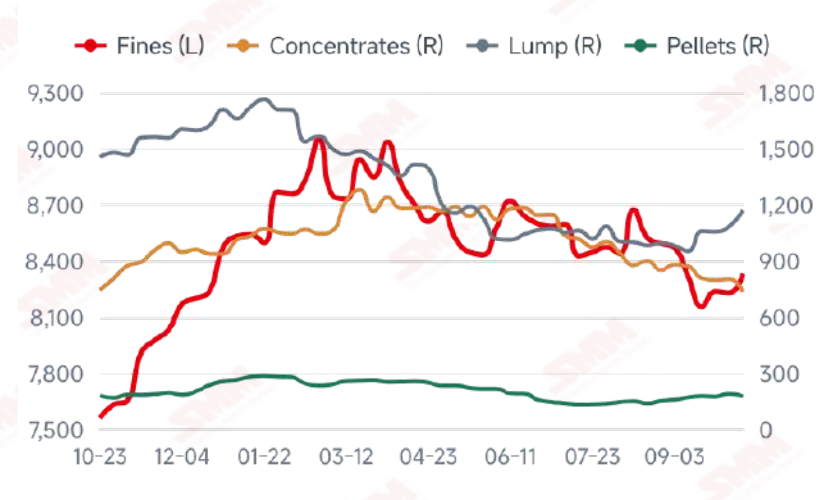
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



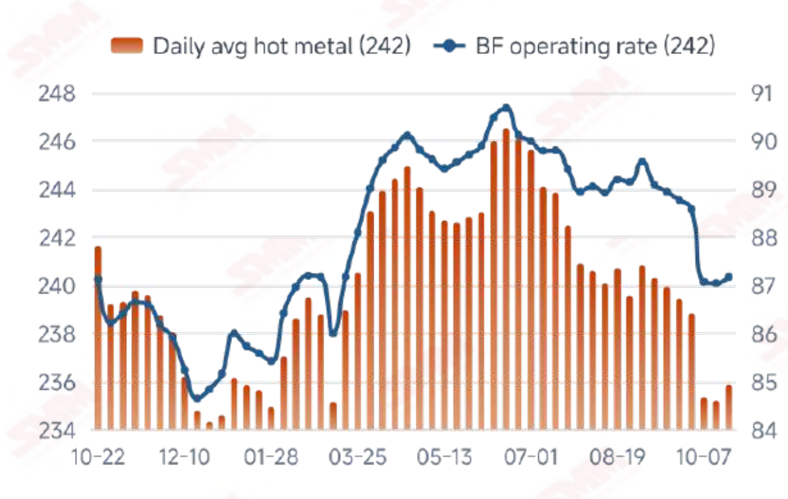
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



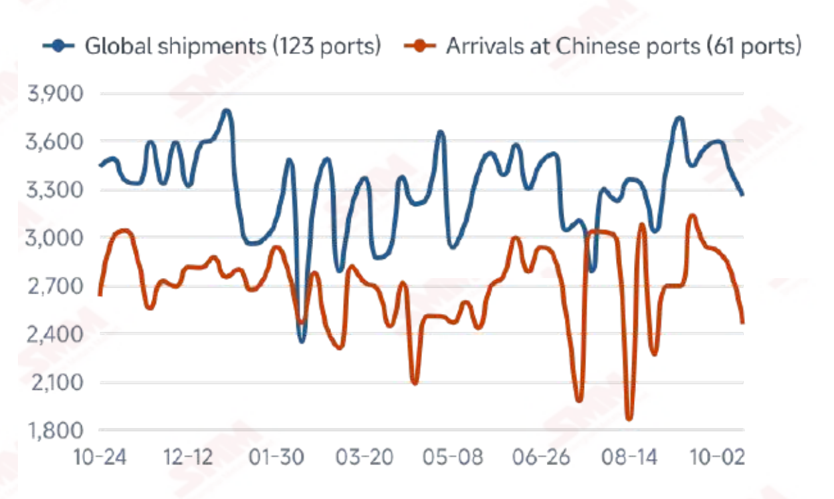
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 669.0 yuan/mt, down 1.83% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 639, Newman Fines 639, Mac Fines 646, BRBF 692, Newman Lump 829, SSF 501, Carajas Fines 814 and PB Lump 819 yuan/wmt, all down 9 yuan. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.55/dmt, timestamped Oct 22, 17:43:50 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review described limited trader willingness to quote, reasonable mill enquiries and needs-based buying with strong pressure on bids.
Drivers	Futures, port spot and seaborne brand quotations moved lower together, showing that earlier pockets of recovery still lack durable support. The seaborne 61% index fell more than the 65%, widening their spread from USD 17.00 to 17.65/dmt. Relative grade performance may reflect supply composition and blending choices, but a one-day spread move does not establish stronger high-grade demand. The next test is whether lower prices generate additional physical transactions.
Demand	SMM's 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt from Oct 14; the blast furnace operating rate rose 0.13 percentage point to 87.16%. Higher output supports baseline raw-material consumption, but purchases also depend on mill stocks, finished-steel orders and margins. Restocking limited to current consumption may offer only modest price support; persistent growth in transactions and collections would better confirm demand recovery.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 32.5276 million mt in the week to Oct 16, down 4.72% WoW, and arrivals in China were 24.5464 million mt, down 12.07%. The latest ten-port inventory was 104.0212 million mt on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30. Lower arrival flows may ease subsequent pressure, but existing stocks still require physical collections for absorption; weaker supply flows should not be equated with realised destocking.
Cost & margin	C3 freight was USD 32.28/mt on Oct 21, up 0.96 (+3.07%) from the previous reading; C5 rose 0.57 (+4.48%) to 13.28. Higher transport costs coexist with lower seaborne quotations, leaving landed costs dependent on contracts and settlement timing. Weaker port selling prices may pressure trading profitability, but the direction of daily ore prices and freight alone cannot establish a specific margin. SMM's assessment published on the morning of Oct 22 put the period's average import margin at 9.79 yuan/mt, up 0.17 yuan from 9.62; this measures import trading, not mill profitability or a post-close calculation for the current session. The first proposed coke increase continued to face mill resistance and should not be treated as a realised cost increase.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	SMM's Oct 22 Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 885–890 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive ex-works basis, up 5 yuan. The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 796.81 yuan/mt on Oct 16; the regional quotation and national index are not directly comparable.
Supply & demand	Tight resources at Tangshan miners and concentrators supported offers, but clear mill losses kept pressure on bids strong. Weaker imported ore could also intensify blending-cost comparisons. A small rise in regional quotations does not establish a broad improvement in domestic ore demand.
Outlook	SMM expects Tangshan concentrate prices to remain soft and range-bound near term. Needs-based mill buying could limit upside, while continued regional resource constraints and stronger collections could make some offers more resilient.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

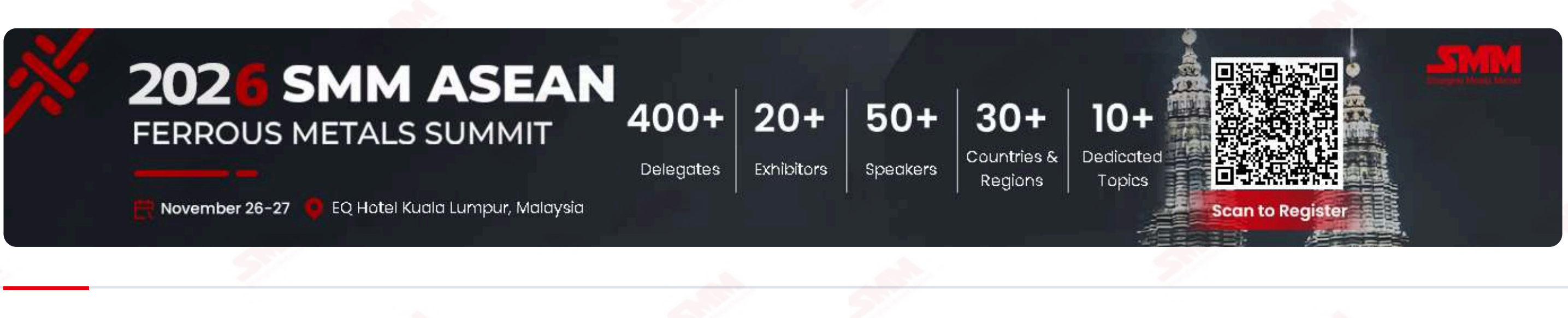
- Latest hot metal output increased 6,400 mt and the blast furnace operating rate edged higher.
- Latest arrivals in China and global shipments both declined WoW.
- Resource constraints in some domestic ore regions may support offers.
- Lower prices could improve demand support if they attract sustained transactions.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE fell 1.83% and all eight port products declined 9 yuan.
- Both seaborne indices and all 12 brand quotations weakened.
- Existing port stocks still require persistent collections for absorption.
- Higher freight may reduce cost advantages for some cargoes.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Anglo American draws down stocks to hold sales; iron ore futures, spot weaker ↗
  2026-10-22
- [Brief Comment on China Iron Ore] Iron ore prices in the Tangshan region are likely to consolidate on a subdued note ↗
  2026-10-22
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261022 ↗
  2026-10-22
- [SMM Steel] Indian Domestic Steel Prices Remain unchanged ↗
  2026-10-22
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Export Prices Flat; Billet Holds at 490–510USD/tonne FOB ↗
  2026-10-22
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian HRC Flat at $515/mt FOB Amid Low Local Demand, Price Pressure Builds in Vietnam ↗
  2026-10-22



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Contact Us – (Email :prices@mmiprices.com)

Shu Qing
Domestic Information Sales
+86 187 8199 7577

Wang Jiahui
Domestic Information Sales
+86 155 2492 4450

Leah Zhang
Overseas Information Sales
+86 136 6193 3462

Jack Teah
Overseas Analyst
+60 11 6680 1225

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